IDEASPRINT 2026

THE INTRA-DEPARTMENTAL START-UP CHALLENGE

PITCHING VIDEO GUIDE

FOR TEAMS

Organized by the Industrial Management Science Students' Association
Department of Industrial Management
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Your pitching video is one of the most important parts of your Phase 1 submission. It is your chance to communicate your idea clearly, confidently, and compellingly. This guide will help you structure and record a strong video that covers everything the evaluation panel needs to see.

1. Video Requirements

- Video must be between **1 to 2 minutes.** Videos shorter than 1 minute or longer than 2 minutes will not be accepted.
- Upload to **YouTube as an Unlisted video** and **include the link** in your proposal submission.
- The pitch may be presented by **one or more team members**. While having a presenter appear in the video is **not compulsory**, it is encouraged.
- **AI-generated** voice-overs are not allowed.
- All content must be in **English.**
- Teams are encouraged to **be creative** in how they present their idea.

2. What the Panel is Looking For

Your video does not need to showcase a working product. What matters is that you can clearly communicate three things:

01	**The Problem**	Is the problem real, specific, and worth solving? Who is affected and how? A strong problem statement sets the foundation for everything else.
02	**The Solution**	What are you building? Even without a prototype, your concept should be clear enough that someone can visualize how it works and why it helps.
03	**The Business Case**	Who are your target users or customers? How does your solution ceate value? Is there a realistic path to sustaniability or revenue?

3. Suggested Video Structure

Below is a recommended structure for a 90-second to 2-minute video. You do not have to follow this exactly, but use it as a reference to ensure your key points are covered.

Time	Section	What to Cover
0:00 - 0:20	Hook + Problem	Open with the problem. Make it real and relatable.
0:20 - 0:50	Your Solution	Introduce your idea. What does it do and how does it work?
0:50 - 1:20	Business Case	Who is this for? How does it create value or generate revenue?
1:20 - 1:40	Wrap Up	Summarize the impact. End with a clear, confident statement.

Tip: You have 2 minutes at most. Every second counts. Cut anything that does not directly support your problem, solution, or business case.

4. Section-by-Section Guidance

4.1 The Hook and Problem Statement

Open with the **problem, not your solution.** Start with a relatable scenario, a surprising fact, or a question that immediately signals why this problem matters. Be **specific about who is affected** and how.

- Avoid **vague openings** like "There is a big problem in the world today."
- Ground the problem in a **real context** that your audience can relate to.
- State **who faces this problem** and how often or severely they face it.

4.2 Your Solution

Introduce your product or idea **clearly.** Explain what it does in **simple terms** before going into how it works. Think of it as explaining your idea to someone who has never heard of it.

- Name your product and describe what it does in **one sentence.**
- Briefly explain the **key feature or mechanism** that solves the problem.
- You **do not need a working prototype.** A concept, wireframe, or diagram is fine.

> Tip: Avoid overly technical explanations at this stage. If a non-expert cannot follow along, simplify.

4.3 Business Case

This section shows that your idea has **potential beyond the concept stage.** You do not need a detailed financial model, but you should be able to answer the basic question: who would pay for this, or who benefits enough to justify building it?

- Identify your **primary target users** or customers.
- Explain how your solution **delivers value** to them.
- Mention a **revenue model, monetization approach, or sustainability plan** if applicable.
- Briefly note the **market opportunity or scale potential.**

4.4 Closing Statement

End with a **clear, confident summary.** Remind the viewer what problem you are solving, what you are building, and why it matters. A **strong close** leaves a lasting impression.

> Tip: Practice your closing line out loud. It should feel natural and not rushed.

5. Recording Tips

- Film in a **quiet space with good lighting.** Natural light works well.
- Use a **stable camera or phone stand.** Shaky footage is distracting.
- **Speak clearly** and at a comfortable pace. Do not rush to fit within the time limit.
- **Dress neatly.** You represent your team and your idea.
- **Practice your script** a few times before recording. You should know your content well enough that you do not have to read word for word.
- **Subtitles or slides** can help if your audio quality is not ideal.
- **Edit out long pauses, mistakes, and filler words** where possible.

6. Common Mistakes to Avoid

Mistake	What to Do Instead
Spending too long on the problem and rushing the solution	Allocate time proportionally across all three sections
Using jargon or technical terms without explanation	Use plain language. Pretend you are explaining to a friend
Describing the product in detail without mentioning the problem	Always lead with the problem first
No mention of the target user or customer	Clearly state who benefits from your solution
Reading directly from a script without looking at the camera	Know your content well enough to speak naturally
Uploading the video as Private instead of Unlisted	Set visibility to Unlisted so evaluators can access it

7. Submission Checklist

Before submitting, make sure you can check off all of the following:

- Video is **between 1 and 2 minutes long**
- Uploaded to YouTube as an **Unlisted video**
- YouTube **link is included** in the proposal submission
- All spoken content is in **English**
- No **AI-generated** voice-overs
- **Problem is clearly stated** with specific context
- **Solution is explained clearly** without unnecessary jargon
- Business case includes **target users and value creation**
- **Closing statement summarizes** the idea confidently
- **Audio is clear,** and video is stable

Good luck. Show us your idea.

For questions, contact the ideasprint 2026 organizing team.

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